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- (1) To understand the contexts where a mental health robot for youth who have been in juvenile detention might exist
- (2) To identify key periods where mental health support is most needed

Mental health care can reduce recidivism rates of youth who have been in juvenile detention [1]. Many access barriers exist [2, 3], and social robots may help resolve them. Before building a mental health robot, we must understand the needs of the population. Specifically:

- How to engage in research with this population
- What robot distribution pathways exist
- What factors influence success in this population

- Focus groups of 3-4 participants are included
- Participants completed journey maps of youth reintegration journeys that mapped key events, stakeholders, emotions, control, and areas of additional mental health support (Fig. 1)
- Participants discussed prompts regarding reintegration success factors
- Thematic analysis was performed on audio transcripts of the discussions

- These results highlight the first focus group
- Mentorship: Having an adult mentor is associated with positive behavior changes and successful community reintegration.
- Activities: Engaging in jobs, volunteering, and school clubs can reduce boredom and promote self-esteem.
- Healthcare: Accessing healthcare is a critical factor in successful community reintegration, but even when available it can be difficult to access.

Mentorship: “... if they have at least one supportive adult in their life, they’re far more likely to be successful and resilient versus if they don’t have a single connection with anyone.”

Activity Engagement: *“I think a part time job or even volunteering or being part of empowerment or something just, like, tangible, where they can say ‘I did this’.”*

Accessibility of Healthcare: “So to get placed in a residential, it now all goes to a specialized placement unit. So every if every county has a local office, if they have a youth that they think needs residential, they do a referral to the specialized placement unit, and...”

[1] Lipsey, M. W. (2009). The primary factors that characterize effective interventions with juvenile offenders: A meta-analytic overview. *Victims and offenders*, 4(2), 124-147.

[2] Udell, W., Mohammed, S., & Breland, D. (2017). Barriers to independently accessing care among detention youth. *Journal of Adolescent Research*, 32(4), 433-455.

[3] US Health Resources and Services Administration. (n.d.). *Health Workforce Shortage Areas*. Shortage Areas. <https://data.hrsa.gov/topics/health-workforce/shortage-areas>

